T–D–568a
March 4, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. T–D–00568(GSA–FSS)
March 27, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DUSTER, VENETIAN BLIND

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a venetian blind duster which consists of a removable split dust-retaining cotton yarn head on a split wire frame attached to a wood handle.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type and grade.* Venetian blind dusters shall be of one type and grade.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

V–T–276—Thread, Cotton.
CCC–T–191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP–B–566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP–B–636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP–B–665—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP–B–676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL–P–116—Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (6.1) before production is commenced, a preproduction sample of the venetian blind duster shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval.

3.2 Figures. Figures incorporated in this specification are included for convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of venetian blind dusters otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Materials. Material shall be as hereinafter specified. Materials not defined herein shall be as regularly used by the manufacturer.

3.3.1 *Duster head.*

3.3.1.1 *Yarn.* The duster head yarn shall be cotton, minimum of 4 ply, approximately 5,040 yds. per lb. and 4.3 turns per inch, with a minimum breaking strength of 9 lbs.

3.3.1.2 *Cloth backing.* The backing shall be cotton duck cloth and shall have a mininum breaking strength of 150 lbs. in the warp and

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130 lbs. in the filling. Yarns per inch shall be a minimum of 72 in the warp and 25 in the filling.

3.3.1.3 *Sewing thread.* The sewing thread shall be type IA1, 4 ply, ticket number 24 in accordance with V–T–276 or comparable thread, with not less than 4.0 lbs. breaking strength.

3.3.1.4 *Tie tapes.* The tie tapes shall be cotton, not less than ½ inch in width, with a minimum breaking strength of 80 lbs.

3.3.2 *Handle and split frame assembly.*

3.3.2.1 *Wood handle.* The handle shall be wood with grain running lengthwise, containing not less than 8 nor more than 12 percent moisture content, and shall be rounded at the hand end and reduced in diameter or tapered at the duster end to accommodate the ferrule. The wood handle shall be 15/16 (±1/16) inch in diameter at the hand end and the remaining portion may be tapered or otherwise shaped for balance and appearance. The portion where the ferrule is attached shall be not less than ¾ inch. The wood handle shall measure 18 (±½) inches overall and shall be free from imperfections such as warp, decay, knots, checks, or any other defects which will affect serviceability. The wood shall be sanded smooth and coated with a clear lacquer, varnish, or similar surface preparation.

3.3.2.2 *Ferrule.* The ferrule shall be a minimum of 1 inch in length and shall have a wall thickness of not less than 0.028 inch. The ferrule shall be made of noncorrosive metal or metal treated for noncorrosion with bright finish.

3.3.2.3 *Wire frame.* The wire frame shall be made of galvanized steel wire. The wire shall be not less than 0.162 inch in diameter.

3.4 Construction and assembly. The manufacturing operations listed in 3.4.1 and 3.4.2 are included as a guide for the contractor in the manufacture of the duster. The contractor is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations as listed. Minor deviations from the specified operations will be allowed where such changes do not lessen serviceability and durability of the end item, and are not in conflict with other requirements of the specification. Figure 1 shows handle, split frame, and duster components. Figure 2 shows assembled duster.

3.4.1 *Duster head construction.* The duster head shall be split for the purpose intended and for secure attachment to the split wire frame. The duster head shall be constructed with a cloth backing, specified in 3.3.1.2, cut 15¾ (±¼) by 4(±¼) inches. The cloth shall be hemmed a minimum of ⅜ inch at each end. Rows of base yarns shall be placed widthwise, each laid side by side, across and stitched securely on the top side of the cloth. The overall length of the base yarns shall be such that after stitching the yarn shall have a free end measuring 1¾ (plus ½, minus ¼) inches extending on both sides of the cloth pieces. There shall be 22 (±2) base yarns per inch.

3.4.1.1 Additional lengthwise and widthwise rows of yarns shall be attached to the duster head as follows:

Two lengthwise rows of yarn, each yarn measuring 4⅛ (±⅜) inches overall, shall be stitched down over the base yarns, with the stitching running parallel to and 1 (±¼) inch from the lengthwise edges of the cloth. One widthwise row of yarn shall be stitched parallel to and ½ inch (plus ¼, minus ⅛) from the edge of each end of cloth. The lengthwise and widthwise rows shall be attached by securely stitching the yarns at their center, so that each yarn shall have two free ends, each end measuring approximately 2 1/16 inches.

3.4.1.2 The cloth shall be folded in half across the width so that all duster yarns are on the outside. The edges of the long sides shall be stitched closed, leaving the end open to form a pocket for the insertion of the frame. The duster shall be slit starting from the center of the folded end for a distance of 4½ (±½) inches to accommodate each extension of the split frame. The duster shall be stitched prior to the slitting operation to prevent any unravelling after slitting. Also, stitching shall be applied to prevent any further splitting of the duster when in use and any openings resulting from the slitting operation shall be closed by stitching.

3.4.1.3 Tie tapes shall be securely attached to the duster head in such a manner that after tying, the duster head will be securely attached to the handle assembly.

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3.4.1.4 The completed duster head shall weigh not less than 4.8 ounces and shall measure 7½ (±½) by 10¾ (±½) inches overall. The duster head shall be washable without significant shrinkage, dry-treated and dust retaining. The completed duster shall have ends of yarns cut evenly and free ends of yarns shall be evenly distributed across mop. All stitching ends and thread breaks shall be backstitched or otherwise securely tacked to prevent unravelling or loosening of the stitching.

3.4.2 *Handle and split frame assembly.* A hole shall be bored 1¾ (±⅜) inches from the duster end of the wood handle. The frame wire shall be inserted through the hole and shall be shaped or formed same as or comparable to that indicated in figure 1, to finish approximately 3 by 7 inches overall for proper placement and fitting of the duster head. A ferrule shall be placed at the duster end of the handle and center punched or otherwise securely attached to the wood handle. There shall be no rough or sharp projections or edges on the handle and split frame assembly which could cause injury to personnel or damage the duster head. The completed handle and split frame assembly shall weight 7 (±2) ounces and shall measure 25 (±1) inches overall.

3.5 Workmanship. The finished dusters shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, inspection shall be made of the completed end item for conformance with all provisions of this specification.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL–STD–105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 *Inspection of components.* Inspection of components and materials shall be in accordance with subsidiary specifications or shall meet the requirements of this specification. This specification shall govern in the event of conflict. Where applicable, CCC–T–191 shall be used.

4.3.2 *Inspection of the end item.* The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with table I and 4.3.2.1. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.2.2.

Table I.—*Classification of defects*

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Handle	Not specified wood.		X
	Slope of grain not running lengthwise.		X
	Any knot hole, loose knot, fracture, split, or other defect affecting serviceability.	X	
	Not sanded smooth.	X	
	Not coated with a clear lacquer, varnish, or similar surface preparation.		X
	Dirt or foreign matter imbedded in finish.		X
	Wet or tacky, area of no film.		X
	Not rounded at handle end.		X
	Out of round (i.e. any flat area or distortion).		X
Split frame	Not shaped as specified.	X	
	Not treated to resist corrosion.		X
	Fractured, split or otherwise impaired.	X	
	Rough or sharp places.	X	
	Damaged.	X	
Ferrule	Missing or not specified type.	X	
	Not treated to resist corrosion.		X

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Table I.—*Classification of defects*—Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Ferrule	Damaged or malformed affecting serviceability.	X	
	Any rough or sharp places.	X	
	Ferrule loosely fit on handle.		X
Duster head	Any section missing.	X	
	Rancid or objectionable odor.		X
	Insect infestation.	X	
	Spotted, soiled or stained.		X
	Tie tape omitted.	X	
	Tie tape not securely attached.		X
	Free ends of yarns not evenly distributed across width of mop, as applicable.	X	
	Mop yarn not caught securely by stitching (simulate by attempting to pull selected yarns out under reasonable tension by hand).		X
	Not dust retaining.	X	
	Any weakening material defect such as hole, tear, cut, smash, or other defect which may develop into a hole or which affects serviceability.	X	

4.3.2.1 *Examination for dimensional characteristics.* The sample unit for this examination shall be one completed duster.

Examine	Defect
Dimensions	Less or more than specified dimensions.

4.3.2.2 *Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's).* Inspection levels and AQL's, expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be as follows. All completed dusters presented at one time for delivery shall be considered a lot for the purpose of acceptance, inspection, and tests.

	Inspection level	AQL
For examination applicable to table I.	I	Major—2.5 Total—6.5
For examination applicable to 4.3.2.1.	S–2	6.5

4.3.3. *Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements.* An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S–2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II.—*Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, waterproof tape.
	Bulging or distortion of container.

4.4 Testing of the end item. The end item components shall be tested for weight as indi-

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cated in 3.4.1.4 and 3.4.2. Any deviation from requirements specified herein shall be considered cause for rejection of the entire lot.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The dusters shall be packaged in accordance with MIL–P–116, method III.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Each duster shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–566, PPP–B–665, or PPP–B–676, type and style optional. The box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The dusters shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The dusters shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–636, class weather-resistant, V3c, style RSC. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape, and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Twenty-four dusters, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP–B–636, type, class, and style optional. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 200 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The dusters shall be packaged to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2. *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) When preproduction sample is required (3.1).

(*c*) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Dusters, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Dusters, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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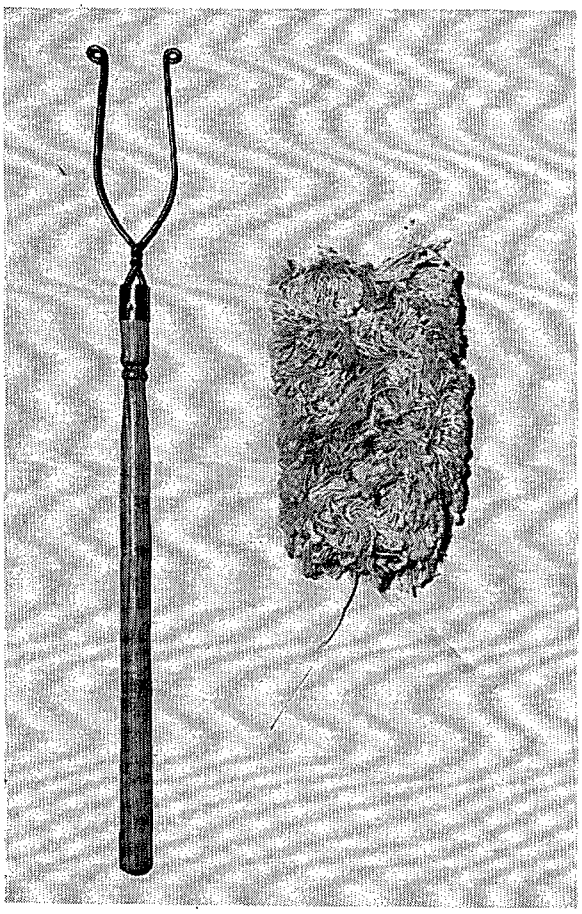


Figure 1

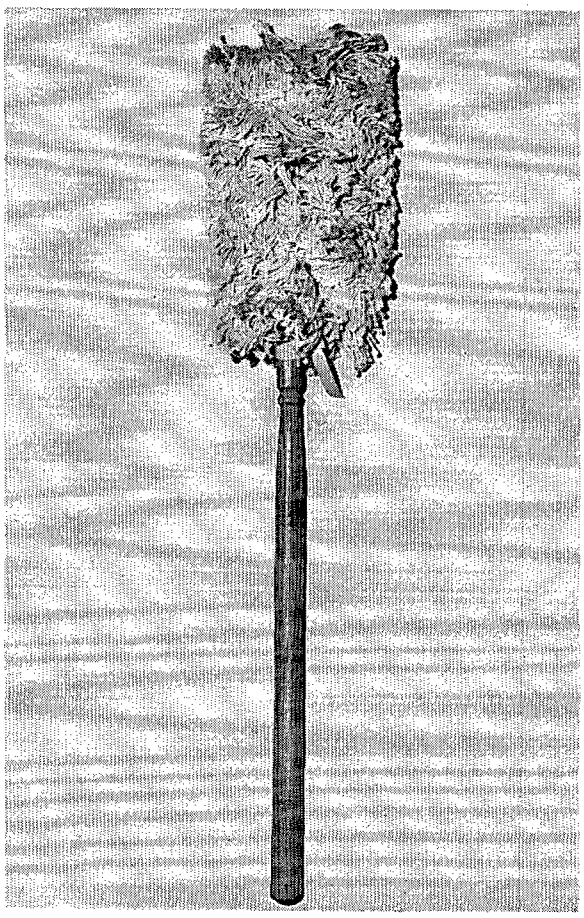


Figure 2

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